

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 1018

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

*Alice Hanlon Peisch*

*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act updating the management of the Commonwealth's water resources.

PETITION OF:

| NAME:                      | DISTRICT/ADDRESS:   | DATE ADDED:      |
|----------------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| <i>Alice Hanlon Peisch</i> | <i>14th Norfolk</i> | <i>1/17/2025</i> |

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 1018

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By Representative Peisch of Wellesley, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1018) of Alice Hanlon Peisch relative to water resources and protecting the rights of municipalities and districts. Environment and Natural Resources.

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[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION  
SEE HOUSE, NO. 879 OF 2023-2024.]

## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

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In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court  
(2025-2026)

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An Act updating the management of the Commonwealth's water resources.

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:*

1           SECTION 1. Section 2 of chapter 21G of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022  
2   Official Edition, is hereby amended by inserting at the end of the definition of “Permit” the  
3   following sentence:-

4           The permit program is intended to assist the department in the comprehensive  
5   management of the commonwealth’s water resources within its river basins in a manner that  
6   ensures an appropriate balance among competing water withdrawals and uses, as well as  
7   preservation of the water resource itself.

SECTION 2. Said section 2 of said chapter 21G of the General Laws, as so appearing, is hereby further amended by inserting at the end of the definition of “Registration statement” the following sentence:-

The registration statement is intended to enable the department to document baseline water use in the commonwealth.

SECTION 3. Section 5 of said chapter 21G of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official Edition, is hereby amended by adding the following paragraph:-

All properly filed water management act renewal registration statements shall entitle the registrants to their registered water use volumes without conditions excepting that the department may require proper metering or other means to accurately measure the volume of water withdrawn under a renewal registration statement. No regulations may be promulgated that would allow the imposition of any such conditions other than withdrawal volume measurement.